country, including one around the time of our visit, in Bagan Pinang, ninety kilometres south of Kuala Lumpur. After the conference, in our WikiLeaks capacity, we toured to speak in different venues and meet with politicians. One of the few ethnic Indian MPs in the mainly Chinese-Malaysian Democratic Action Party took us to a former rubber plantation, where we met three generations of Indian workers who had been born, educated and employed on the same land. They showed us pamphlets that had been distributed by representatives of the governing party, along with money intended as a vote-buying bribe. Despite this obvious evidence of the corruption endemic in the political system and the unwillingness of the governing party to bring about change in their lives, these people were not morose, not fatalistic, not beaten.

I met with Anwar Ibrahim, and quickly Rop and I found ourselves immersed in Malaysian political dynamics. It was head-spinning how quickly the sand was moving under everybody's feet – a foretaste, you might say, of what would be happening in Cairo and Tunisia and Libya within two years, but we'll come to that. Ibrahim seemed to have his finger on the pulse of change, but needed support and information and publicity advice. WikiLeaks had helped to publicise a very sensitive document about the death of a Mongolian woman, Altantuya Shaariibuu, who had been killed in an explosion near Kuala Lumpur in 2006. The document made allegations of extraordinary seriousness surrounding her death.

The document itself was a statutory declaration signed by Raja Petra, the editor of a campaigning online news site, *Malaysia Today*.

Petra had been so under threat from the authorities – evading two arrest warrants – that the website had had to move its service to Singapore and the USA. Meanwhile, the subject of Shaariibuu's murder had become so incendiary that it could scarcely be mentioned in Malaysia. If it was mentioned at a political rally, the riot squad were immediately sent in. I often want to tell this to people who feel that a single document can't make a difference.

I told Ibrahim that this leak was a powerful lever. The reaction to it revealed an incredible weak spot in the government: they feared reform more than they knew how to resist it. The reform movement was being reactive in its press campaigns and our advice was to get off the back foot. They had to get ahead of the government's media line – the government had the stronger voice but the weaker heart – and we fed them material. By the